MICS Plus Tabulation

A step-by-step guide to using the application

MICS Team

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About micsPlusTableR

micsPlusTableR is the R package behind the **MICS Plus Tabulation** application. It was created primarily to support this browser-based app for preparing, tabulating, reviewing, and exploring MICS Plus survey data. R performs the calculations; the app provides controls for selecting inputs, running analyses, and examining results.

Most other package functions perform background tasks for the app or expose its calculation engine. They are documented for understanding the system, testing, and working directly in R. You do not need to call them individually when using the app.

Purpose. The system connects the tables you want to produce with the data and preparation steps needed to calculate them. A tabulation plan in Excel records the table definitions, while a survey-specific R script prepares the data and variables. This makes it possible to apply a supplied plan or create and adapt a plan for your own reporting and analysis needs, then repeat the calculations when inputs or specifications change.

Inputs. The application uses four matching inputs for a survey:

- **Household data**, supplied as an SPSS `.sav` file.
- **Household-member data**, supplied as a separate SPSS `.sav` file.
- **A tabulation plan (Excel)**, specifying table layouts, row and column groups, conditions, statistics, and display settings.
- **A preparation folder**, containing the R script and any supporting files needed to prepare the data used by the plan.

Features. You can obtain supplied plans and preparation materials, prepare survey data, calculate a selected table, review consistency checks, and run several tables together. The application also lets you inspect prepared data, explore frequencies and cross-tabulations, and combine calculated table cells into a data file for further use. Worksheet filters, weights, statistics, and display settings control the tables you define.

Results and outputs. Choose the form that serves your task:

- **Results in the application:** table previews, check results, prepared data views, and exploratory analyses. Looking at a table in Tabulator may be all you need; writing it to Excel is not required.
- **Excel table workbooks:** save calculated tables in their worksheet layouts for review, reporting, or sharing.
- **Combined table data:** download calculated cells in Excel, CSV, or RDS format for further analysis or exchange.
- **R objects:** use the package functions in a scripted workflow.

These are different ways to use the system, not a single sequence that must end in an export. Choose the relevant tools after preparing your inputs. Save or download results when you need to retain them beyond the current app session.

Ways to use the system

Choose the route that matches how you obtain or develop your table definitions. Either route can support viewing results in the app, reviewing them, or producing files.

Two main routes

1. **Run an existing tabulation plan.** Use the plan and preparation files supplied by the MICS team or your survey team, together with the corresponding data. This route is for users producing tables from an agreed specification. You can run, check, and export the tables without writing calculations or changing the preparation code.
2. **Create or adapt a tabulation plan.** Design the tabulation plan for the tables you need, then apply it with a compatible preparation script and the corresponding data. This route is for plan authors and analysts who define row and column groups, statistics, filters, weights, and display settings. Use an existing working plan as a starting point where possible, keeping the worksheet structure the app expects. Check that variables used by the plan are available after preparation. If new or changed variables are needed, update the preparation script with the person responsible for that code.

Different users, shared checks. Table producers can use the app instructions for the tasks they need. Anyone who wants to understand how a table is created can use Understand the tabulation plan, whether reading an existing plan or editing one. Reviewers can focus on the plan's definitions, calculated results, consistency checks, and exported tables. Users maintaining preparation scripts or running the workflow directly in R can use the package reference linked under Terms and reference information. One user may take several of these roles.

After changing a plan or preparation script, load the updated inputs and rerun the affected tables and checks. Users can move between table production, plan development, and data exploration as their work requires.

Find the task you need

The entries below cover the whole guide and link to its sections. The numbers help you find instructions; they do not mean every task must be completed. Set up the system and prepare the inputs you need, then choose the tools that serve your purpose.

Set up the system and inputs

1. **Set up your computer** - install R and an editor such as RStudio.
2. **Create or open a survey project** - choose where your work belongs.
3. **Install the package and start the app** - install micsPlusTableR in R, open the app in your web browser, and use the User's Guide tab.
4. **Gather your survey files** - obtain or prepare a compatible plan, preparation script, and survey data.
5. **Load and prepare your data** - load your inputs and prepare the data.

Calculate, review, explore, and save results

6. **Calculate and look at one table** - use Tabulator to calculate a worksheet and inspect its result.
7. **Check the table** - compare related counts and percentages with Consistency Checks.
8. **Save the reviewed table to Excel** - write a table when you need a saved workbook.
9. **Run several tables together** - calculate and write selected sheets, then review the run summary.
10. **Explore a question** - examine frequencies or cross-tabulations with Data Exploration.
11. **Look at prepared data** - inspect selected household or household-member variables in Data View.
12. **Download a data file** - combine calculated table cells in Long Format Data where each row corresponds to one cell in the output table, and download them as Excel, CSV, or RDS.

Manage your session

13. **Finish, return later, or get help** - retain any results you need, close or reopen the app, and troubleshoot.

Reference sections

- **Understand the tabulation plan** - locate datasets, prepare conditions for the intended outputs, and choose statistics and display settings. See row and column conditions for understanding how the row and
  column conditions are handled.
- **Other editors and code systems** - use the package with an R environment other than RStudio.
- **Terms and reference information** - find definitions, notes about the screenshots, and links to the package reference.

1. Set up your computer

Choose where to run R

If you are new to R, follow the RStudio Desktop steps below. R does the calculations; RStudio gives you a window in which to start them. These are two separate programs. The tabulation application then runs in your web browser. You only need to copy a few commands; the table-making steps use buttons.

An **IDE** is a program that brings together tools for working with code. The package can run in an R session started from different editors and code systems. You only need one of these options:

Option	What you need to know
RStudio Desktop	The route explained here, with an R Console and a project menu. Install R separately.
Positron	An alternative with built-in R support. Install R, open your survey folder, and choose an R session.
Visual Studio Code (VS Code)	Install R and configure the R extension; run the commands in an R terminal.
Cursor	Use its code editor with R installed and a compatible R extension, or start R in its terminal.
JupyterLab / Jupyter Notebook	Use an R kernel, such as IRkernel. This requires extra setup.
R's own console / a terminal	Run the same R commands from your survey folder. No separate IDE is required.

For setup details, see Positron's R guide, VS Code's R guide, Cursor's extension guide, and IRkernel for Jupyter. The other environments section explains project folders and browser access for these routes. The remaining click-by-click computer setup instructions use RStudio Desktop.

Install R, then RStudio Desktop (once)

If both programs already open on your computer, go to Create or open your survey project. You need internet access for installation. Use a recent R version supported by your editor; the package requires **R 4.2 or later**. You also need a web browser and an Excel viewer to review the saved workbooks. The workbook preview may also need internet when the app opens; see Internet access and the workbook preview for the role of browser caching.

Install R first

1. Open your web browser and go to the official R download site.
2. **Windows:** click **Download R for Windows**, then **base**, then the download link for R. Open the downloaded `.exe` file from **Downloads**. Follow the installer, using its standard options, and click **Finish**.
3. **Mac:** click **Download R for macOS**. Choose the `.pkg` installer matching your Mac and macOS version. **Apple menu > About This Mac** shows whether your Mac has an Apple chip or an Intel processor. Open the downloaded file and follow the installer.
4. **Linux:** follow the R download page's instructions for your Linux distribution.

Install RStudio Desktop next

1. Go to Posit's RStudio Desktop download page. Choose the **free RStudio Desktop** download for your operating system.
2. **Windows:** open the downloaded installer and follow its steps.
   Mac: open the downloaded `.dmg` and drag RStudio into **Applications**.
   Linux: use the installer and instructions for your distribution.
3. Open **RStudio** from the Windows **Start** menu or Mac **Applications**. If it asks you to choose R, select the version you just installed.
4. Find the **Console** panel. When you see a `>` prompt, R is ready.

Ready to continue: RStudio opens and its Console shows `>`. If you see "R not found," finish installing R, close RStudio, and reopen it. If your computer requires an administrator password you do not have, ask your IT support person to complete the installation.

2. Create or open your survey project

Do this before starting the application. Create or open a project folder for your survey work. It keeps your files and generated results together. Choose the appropriate route below and use a memorable name, such as **Mongolia-Wave1**; substitute your own survey.

New work: create a new project folder

1. In RStudio, click **File > New Project**.
2. Choose **New Directory**, then **New Project**.
3. Under **Directory name**, enter your survey project name.
4. Beside **Create project as subdirectory of**, click **Browse** and choose a location you can find again, such as **Documents**.
5. Click **Create Project**. RStudio creates and opens the folder.

You already have a folder, but no .Rproj file

1. Click **File > New Project > Existing Directory**.
2. Click **Browse** and choose your existing survey folder.
3. Click **Create Project**. RStudio adds a project file to that folder; your existing survey files stay in place.

You already have an RStudio project

1. Click **File > Open Project**.
2. Find your survey folder, select its **.Rproj** file, and click **Open**. You can also double-click that file in File Explorer or Finder.

These routes follow the RStudio project instructions. To switch surveys later, stop the app and use **File > Open Project** again.

Check your location: the project name should appear at the top right of RStudio.

Your files: keep your supplied survey data, tabulation plan, and complete preparation folder inside an **inputs** subfolder if convenient. Copying files into the project does not load them into the app; you will select them with **Browse** during Data Preparation. Files may also remain in another accessible folder. Keep the project available while working; extract ZIP folders first if you downloaded the inputs as ZIP folders.

The app normally creates **micsPlusTableR-output** inside your project for Excel results. Browser downloads may go to **Downloads** instead. The **Write to Excel** screen shows the actual saved workbook paths.

3. Install the package and start the app

Install the micsPlusTableR package (once)

1. Keep your survey project open. Click the **Console** beside `>`. Use the **Console**, rather than the **Terminal** tab or a search box.
2. **Install `remotes` only if it is not already available in your R library. Once installed, you do not need to install it again:** skip the first line on later uses. Run the second line to install **micsPlusTableR**. Paste each needed command into the Console and press **Enter**. Wait for `>` to return before running the next command:

```
install.packages("remotes")
remotes::install_github("bariscr/micsPlusTableR")
```

`remotes` is the helper that installs the application package from GitHub. The second command installs **micsPlusTableR** and its required packages, including those used by the supported survey preparation scripts. This may take several minutes. Leave RStudio open while messages scroll.

3. If R asks to create a personal library, accept it. If asked to choose a CRAN download mirror, choose **0-Cloud** if offered. If a menu lists packages with newer versions, enter the number for your choice and press **Enter**:

   - **All:** update all packages listed in that menu. Choose this when setting up a new working environment or when you want to bring the listed packages up to date and have time to check your work with the updated versions. Installation may take longer.
   - **None:** keep the versions already installed. Choose this when your current setup works and you want to keep those versions while continuing an analysis. Required packages that are missing will still be installed.

   All refers to the packages listed for this installation, not every package available for R. If installation reports that a named package is too old, update that package, or choose **All** to update all listed packages, then retry. You do not need to update everything to resolve a problem with one package. See the package-update guidance.

4. If an error appears, copy the message and ask your IT support for help. For folder or lock errors, see Installation cannot finish.

You normally install once for the R library you use, not once per survey or on every launch. A different R installation or an isolated project library may need its own package installation. To update, finish and save your work and stop the app. Run the GitHub installation command again, choose package updates as described above, and restart R before using the updated package.

Start the application (each time you work)

1. Open your survey project in either of these ways: double-click its **.Rproj** file in File Explorer or Finder, or in RStudio choose **File > Open Project**, select the **.Rproj** file, and click **Open**. Confirm the project name at the top right of RStudio. You do not need to repeat installation for ordinary launches.
2. In the **Console**, paste this line and press **Enter**:

```
micsPlusTableR::run_app()
```

3. The application opens in a browser on **Data Preparation**. On a narrow window, use **Toggle navigation** to see the tabs. If you need plans or preparation files, open **Download Files**.
4. Gather your survey files, then use Data Preparation to select the country and wave, upload the files, and click **Set**.

You are ready when: you can open **Download Files**, **Data Preparation**, **Tabulator**, **Consistency Checks**, and **Write to Excel** across the top.

While working: keep RStudio (or your chosen R environment) and the application open. A busy Console without a > prompt is normal while the app runs. Do not paste more commands there. Do not refresh the browser; you may lose work not yet written to Excel.

No browser window? Find the address beginning `http://127.0.0.1:` in the Console. Copy the complete address into your browser's address bar and press **Enter**. The number at the end can change each time you start.

Where the work happens: with this local setup, the browser connects to R on your computer. Selecting input files loads them into the running app; it does not install them into the package. Opening a project later does not restore the app's uploaded inputs or unsaved results.

If the app does not start, read the Console message and check the package setup instructions. Include the complete message when requesting technical help.

Use the User's Guide tab

User's Guide is the first tab in the app's navigation bar. Open it at any point to read the instructions while keeping the app open.

- Read the guide inside the tab and use **Find the task you need** to jump to a section.
- Click **Open full guide** to open the guide in a separate browser tab. This lets you keep the instructions beside the app while you work.
- Click **Download PDF** to save a copy for offline reading or printing. Find it in your browser's downloads or the download location you chose.

Return to the relevant app tab to continue your work. Opening the guide does not reset your inputs or results. The app sections in this guide follow the navigation bar: **Download Files**, **Data Preparation**, **Tabulator**, **Consistency Checks**, **Write to Excel**, **Multi-Sheet Tabulator**, **Data Exploration**, **Data View**, then **Long Format Data**. You can use each tool when you need it; this order is not a requirement to complete every tab.

Internet access and the workbook preview

Why the preview uses a browser library. The workbook preview in **Data Preparation** shows the uploaded tabulation plan (Excel) inside the app. A browser cannot display an Excel workbook as a table on its own, so the app uses a JavaScript library called **SheetJS** to read it and convert the selected sheet into a displayable table. You do not need to install this library yourself. It is separate from the calculations performed by R and the calculated table preview in **Tabulator**.

When internet is needed. When the app opens, the browser loads SheetJS from **cdn.jsdelivr.net** if it cannot reuse a saved copy. In a local RStudio session, the workbook itself is read from the running app on your computer; the preview code does not send it to that external server. Once the library has loaded, changing the preview sheet does not require downloading the library again while that app page stays open.

What caching means for later use. The browser may keep a copy of the library in its cache and reuse it on later visits, avoiding another download. However, caching is **not a guarantee of offline access**: the copy can be cleared or expire, and another browser or a private window may not have it. Browser settings can also require a new request.

Before working offline: open the app while connected, upload the plan, and check that its workbook preview appears. Keep that app page and R session open. Calculations and Excel output do not depend on SheetJS; with the required packages and input files available locally, they do not need this external download. Installation, **Download Files**, and retrieving cloud-only inputs still need internet. If only the workbook preview fails, you can inspect the plan in Excel and continue tabulating.

4. Gather your survey files

You need two sets of files for the **same survey (country, period, and wave)**:

- **Household and household-member data (`.sav`):** obtain them from the MICS surveys page with the required permission. These data are never distributed through the files repository or the package's download functions.
- **Tabulation plans and preparation files:** use a compatible set you have created or adapted, or download supplied materials from micsPlusTableR-Files using the app or one of the alternatives below. These downloads require no GitHub account once the repository is public.

If your inputs are already available, go to Check your input set. Otherwise, use one of the download routes below for supplied plans and preparation files.

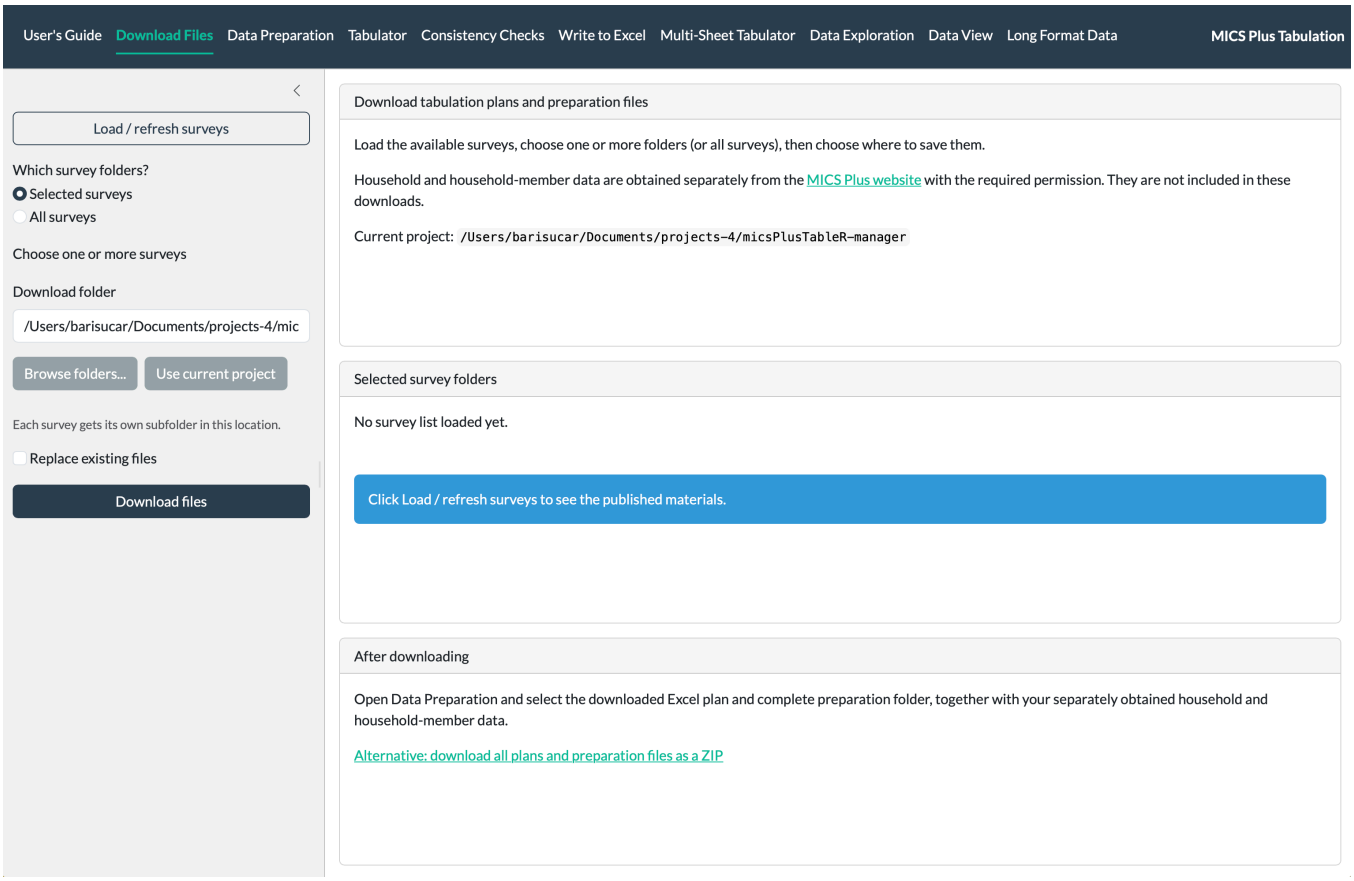
Download with the app

Surveys are named by country, survey period, and wave, for example **Jamaica (2023-24) Wave 1**. The download choices and survey folders use the same names. Each survey contains its tabulation plan and a `prep-files-` folder with the matching survey name. Keep the preparation folder and its contents together.

1. Open **Download Files** and click **Load / refresh surveys**. Internet access and a public files repository are needed to load the list.
2. To download **one** folder, keep **Selected surveys** and tick that survey, such as `Jamaica (2023-24) Wave 1`. To download **several**, tick each survey you want. For **every** published survey folder, select **All surveys**.
3. Review **Selected survey folders** for the file count and total size.
4. Check **Download folder**. It starts at the current project you opened before launching the app. For example, selecting `Jamaica (2023-24) Wave 1` saves its materials in a `Jamaica (2023-24) Wave 1` subfolder directly inside that project.
5. To choose another destination, click **Browse folders...**, select a folder, and click **Select**, or type a path. You may create a folder in the picker. A relative path such as `inputs` means a subfolder of the current project. **Use current project** restores the original default.
6. Leave **Replace existing files** off to protect local copies. If the selected files already exist, use a different folder or turn it on deliberately.
7. Click **Download files** and wait for the success message, which shows where the files were saved. The preparation subfolders are preserved.

Files are saved directly by R to the chosen location. They do not go through your browser's **Downloads** folder. In a remotely hosted R session, the path is on that remote machine; use your host's file access tools to retrieve files.

Download Files screen



This picture shows the screen before **Load / refresh surveys** is clicked. Your own project path appears in **Download folder**. After loading, the available survey checkboxes appear under **Choose one or more surveys**.

Alternative: download a ZIP through your browser

1. Click Download all plans and preparation files (ZIP).
2. Find the ZIP in **Downloads**. On Windows, right-click it and choose **Extract All**; on a Mac, double-click it.
3. Open the extracted `micsPlusTableR-Files-main` folder. Copy the survey folder you need, such as `Jamaica (2023-24) Wave 1`, into your survey project's **inputs** folder. Keep its preparation folder and all subfolders together.

Alternative: download from the R Console

Open your survey project. Run these commands in the **R Console before starting the app**. If the app is running, stop it first so the `>` prompt returns. First list the available surveys:

```
available <- micsPlusTableR::list_survey_files()
unique(available$survey)
```

Choose **one** of these alternatives:

```
# One survey
micsPlusTableR::download_survey_files("Jamaica (2023-24) Wave 1")

# Several surveys
micsPlusTableR::download_survey_files(c(
  "Jamaica (2023-24) Wave 1",
  "Mongolia (2025-26) Wave 2"
))

# All published surveys
micsPlusTableR::download_survey_files()
```

The Console function defaults to **inputs** under `getwd()`, while the app tab defaults to the project itself. Console downloads preserve the survey and preparation subfolders. Use `dest_dir = "other-folder"` to choose another destination. Existing files are protected: use a new folder, or add `overwrite = TRUE` only when you intend to replace them.

For individual files, inspect `available$path` and pass the exact paths:

```
micsPlusTableR::download_survey_files(
  files = available$path[1],
  dest_dir = "selected-inputs"
)
```

Select a whole survey folder to include its preparation helpers. Add the separately authorized household/member data before running the app. If GitHub limits requests, retry later or use the ZIP link.

Check your input set

Keep these **four items for the same country, period, and wave** together in your survey project's **inputs** folder, or another folder you can find again. The household and household members data files come from the MICS Plus website with permission. Use a tabulation plan and preparation folder supplied by your team or downloaded from `micsPlusTableR-Files`, or your own compatible versions. Once all four items are ready, continue to Data Preparation in the app.

Item to obtain	How to recognize it	Where it goes in the app
Household data	Name often ends in `hh.sav`	**Select household file**
Household members data	Name often ends in `hl.sav`	**Select household members file**
Tabulation plan	Excel file ending in `.xlsx`	**Select tabulation file**
Preparation folder	Folder containing the preparation script and its supporting files	**Select preparation folder**

Your team may supply longer names. Do not rename the files just to match the pictures. When running an existing plan, you do not need to open the `.sav` files or edit the preparation code. When creating or adapting a plan, check its variable names and definitions against the prepared data and script before running it.

5. Load and prepare your data

Open **Data Preparation** in the app. Use the controls below to select your files and preparation folder, then follow **Run Data Preparation** to check the survey choices and click **Set**.

How to choose a file

1. Click **Browse...** beside the relevant item in the application.
2. In the window that opens, find the folder containing your inputs. If it was downloaded, first look in **Downloads**.
3. Double-click a folder to open it. Click the required file once to select it.
4. Click **Open**. Wait until its name appears in the application and the upload finishes. Repeat for the other files.

How to choose the preparation folder

1. If the team supplied a ZIP file, extract it first: on Windows, right-click it and choose **Extract All**; on a Mac, double-click it.
2. Beside **Select preparation folder**, click **Browse...**.
3. Select the folder that contains the preparation file, then click **Upload**, **Select**, or **Open**, depending on your browser. **Select the folder itself, rather than an individual file inside it**.
4. If the browser asks to upload the folder's files, check its name and confirm.

Check before continuing: use the complete preparation folder for the selected survey. Keep any folders inside it, such as **FIES-inputs**, in place. Check the preparation script's file references if you are unsure which supporting files belong with it.

Run Data Preparation

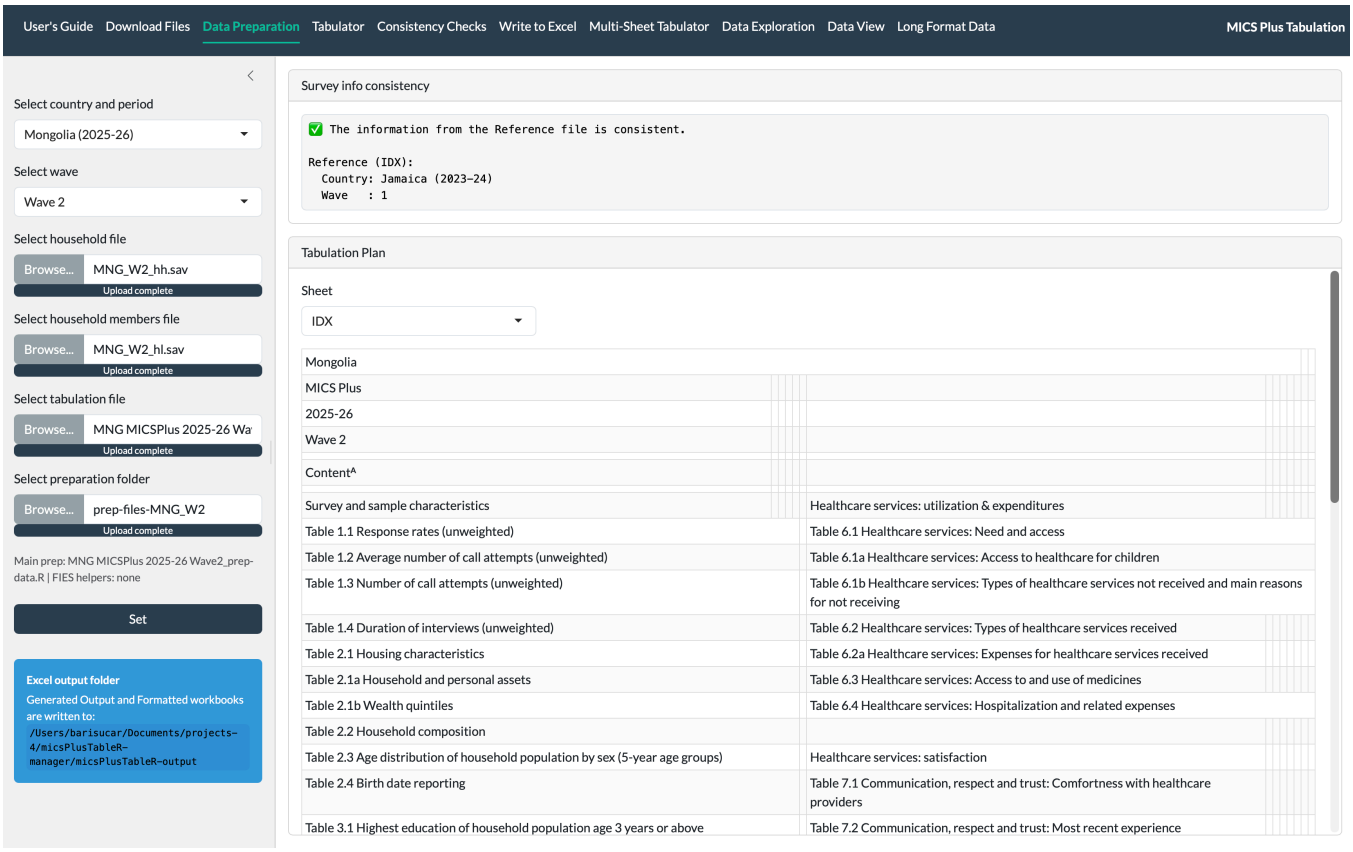
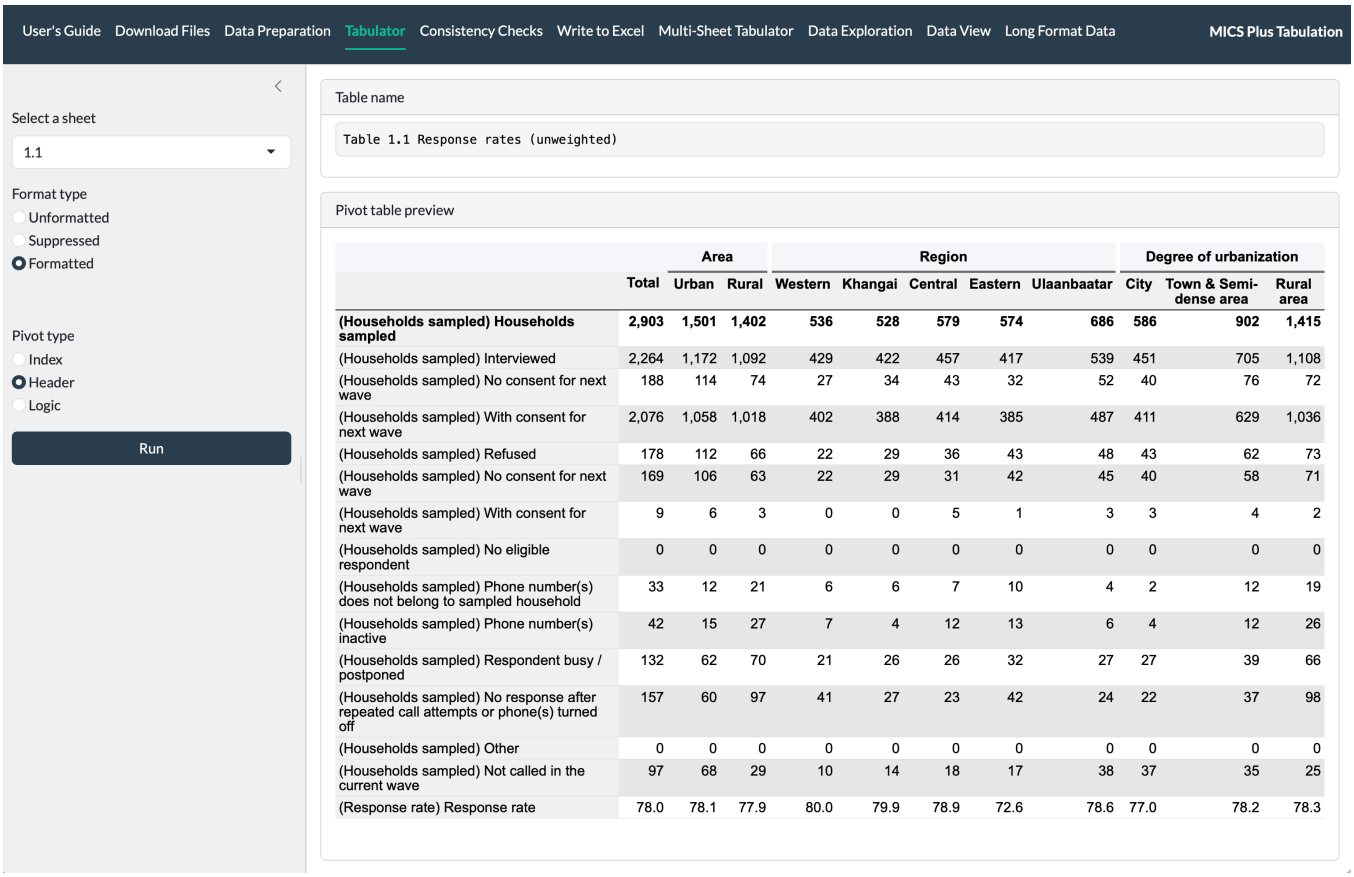


Figure 1: Data Preparation: Mongolia Wave 2 inputs are selected on the left; the survey consistency result and IDX sheet of the tabulation plan appear on the right.

1. Click **Data Preparation**. Under **Select country and period**, click the small arrow and choose your survey. Choose the matching **wave** below it.
2. Use the four **Browse...** controls to choose the files and select the preparation folder.
3. Read **Main prep** below the folder control. Check that it names the intended preparation file. **FIES helpers: none** is normal for surveys without FIES.
4. Click **Set** once. If it is below the visible area, scroll down inside the left panel. Wait for preparation to finish.
5. Read **Survey info consistency** at the upper right. Check the country, period, and wave. The example says the reference information is consistent.

Ready to continue: the survey details agree and there is no preparation error. A matching survey message alone does not resolve a separate error. If a mismatch or error appears, compare the selected country and wave with the tabulation plan's IDX sheet, and inspect the reported preparation error before continuing.

6. Calculate and look at one table



		Area		Region					Degree of urbanization		
	Total	Urban	Rural	Western	Khangai	Central	Eastern	Ulaanbaatar	City	Town & Semi-dense area	Rural area
(Households sampled) Households sampled	**2,903**	**1,501**	**1,402**	**536**	**528**	**579**	**574**	**686**	**586**	**902**	**1,415**
(Households sampled) Interviewed	2,264	1,172	1,092	429	422	457	417	539	451	705	1,108
(Households sampled) No consent for next wave	188	114	74	27	34	43	32	52	40	76	72
(Households sampled) With consent for next wave	2,076	1,058	1,018	402	388	414	385	487	411	629	1,036
(Households sampled) Refused	178	112	66	22	29	36	43	48	43	62	73
(Households sampled) No consent for next wave	169	106	63	22	29	31	42	45	40	58	71
(Households sampled) With consent for next wave	9	6	3	0	0	5	1	3	3	4	2
(Households sampled) No eligible respondent	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
(Households sampled) Phone number(s) does not belong to sampled household	33	12	21	6	6	7	10	4	2	12	19
(Households sampled) Phone number(s) inactive	42	15	27	7	4	12	13	6	4	12	26
(Households sampled) Respondent busy / postponed	132	62	70	21	26	26	32	27	27	39	66
(Households sampled) No response after repeated call attempts or phone(s) turned off	157	60	97	41	27	23	42	24	22	37	98
(Households sampled) Other	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
(Households sampled) Not called in the current wave	97	68	29	10	14	18	17	38	37	35	25
(Response rate) Response rate	78.0	78.1	77.9	80.0	79.9	78.9	72.6	78.6	77.0	78.2	78.3

1. Click **Tabulator** at the top.
2. Under **Select a sheet**, click the arrow. Choose the table code that you require. The picture uses **1.1**.
3. Leave **Format type** on **Formatted** and **Pivot type** on **Header** for an easy-to-read preview.
4. Click **Run** once and wait for the table to appear.
5. Read **Table name** above the result. Check that it is the table you intended to produce. Scroll inside the preview to see more rows or columns.

Ready to continue: the correct table name and calculated values appear. Use **Consistency Checks** to review the applicable comparisons. If viewing the result meets your need, you do not have to export it. Use **Write to Excel** when you want to keep a table workbook; the preview itself does not save one.

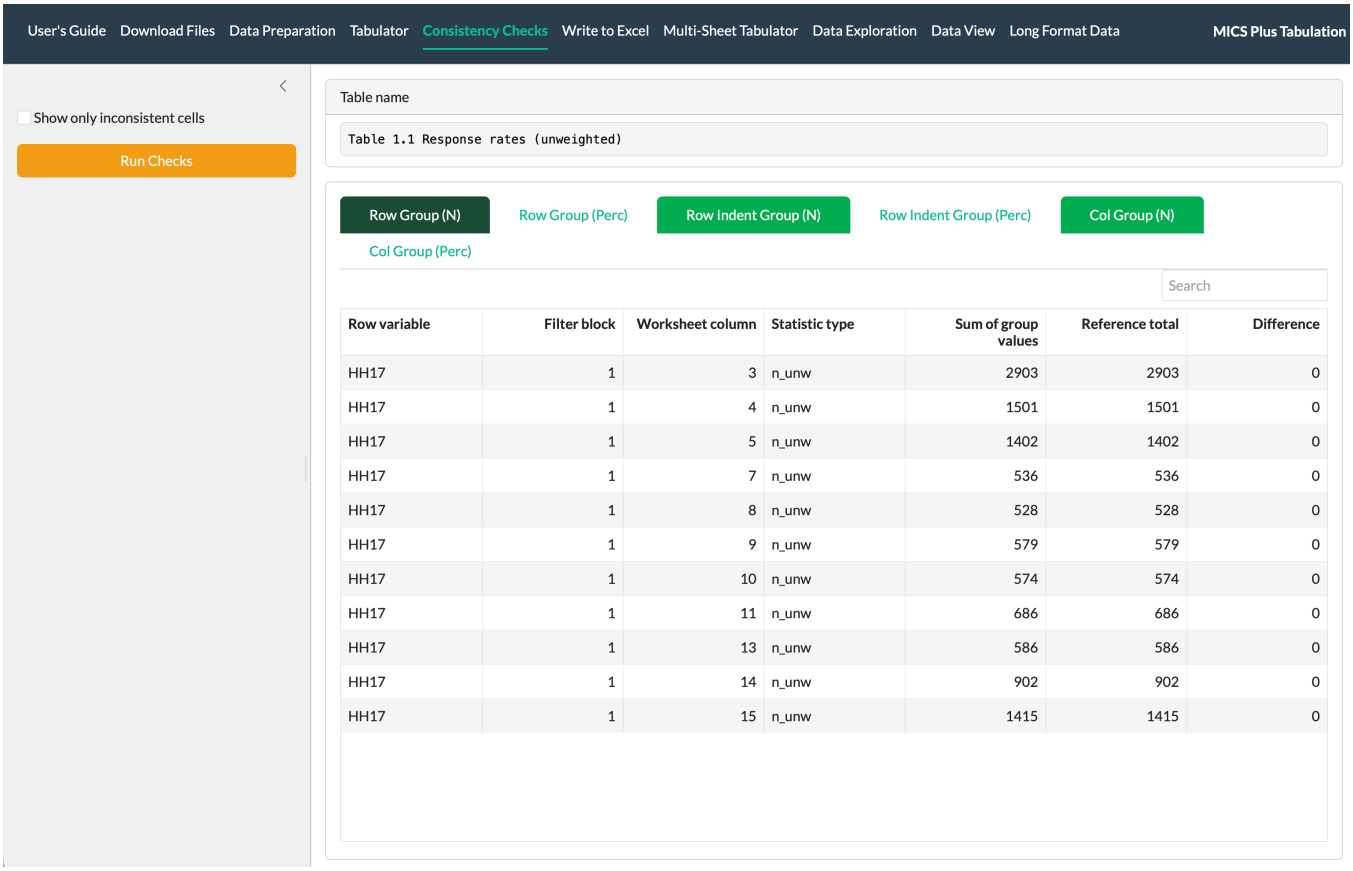
If you require plain numbers, choose **Unformatted**. Choose **Suppressed** to inspect the sampling display rules.

Choose the labels with Pivot type:

Option	What it shows and when to use it
Header	Descriptive row and column labels from the tabulation plan. Use this to read and interpret the table.
Index	The worksheet's row and column numbers. Use this to locate a result in the tabulation plan; for example, row 9 and column 6 identify cell F9.
Logic	The row and column conditions used for the table. Use this to inspect the expressions behind the groups being compared.

Pivot type changes the preview labels, not the calculated values. Choose the view you need, then click **Run** to refresh the preview.

7. Check the table



1. Click **Consistency Checks**. Confirm the **Table name** matches the table you just ran.
2. Click **Run Checks** and wait for the results.
3. Click each of the smaller check tabs, such as **Row Group (N)**. They compare counts or percentages in different parts of the table.
4. If a tab is red, tick **Show only inconsistent cells** to find the differences. Inspect the affected groups, their filters, and their denominators to identify the cause.

Green: this check ran and found no difference beyond its tolerance.

Red: a difference needs review.

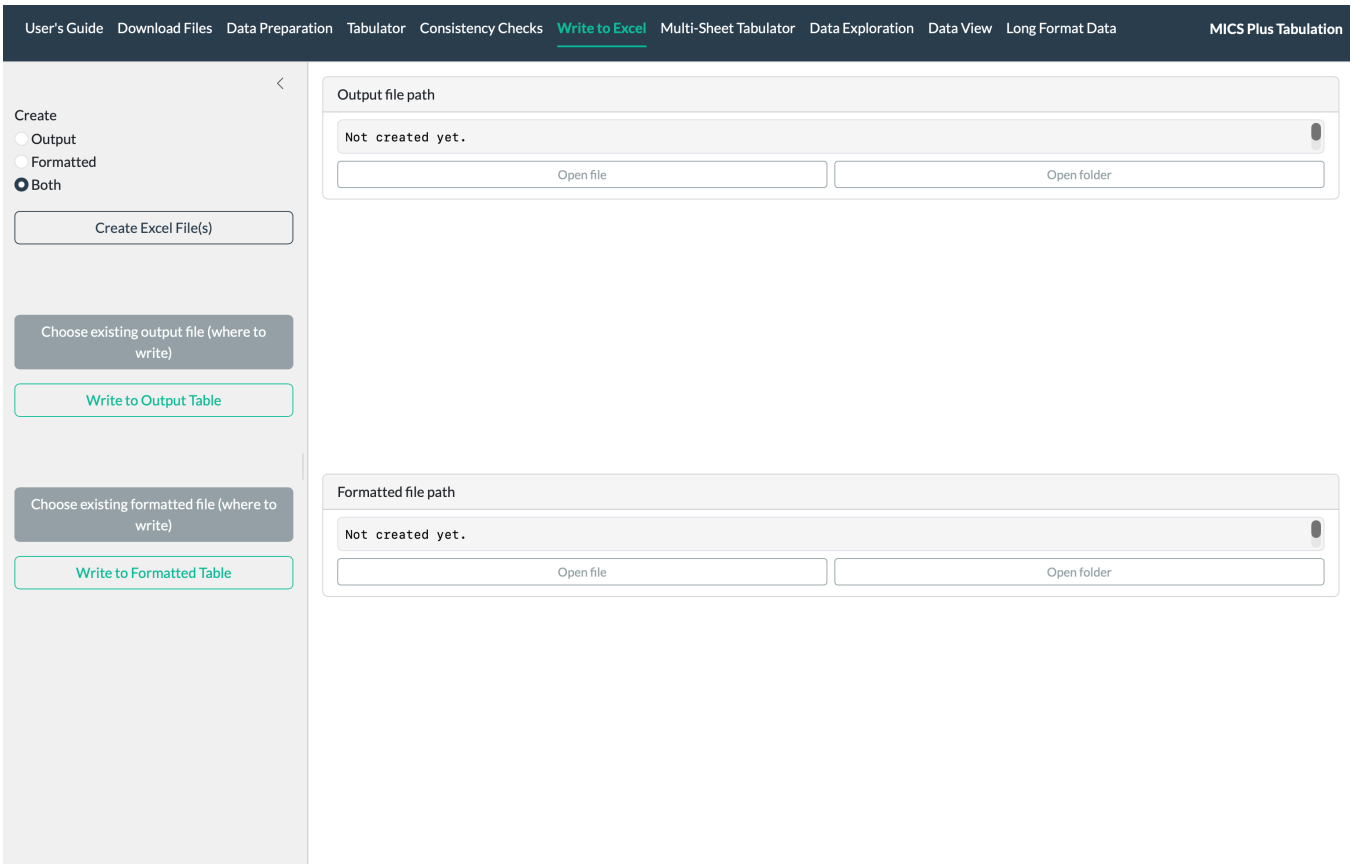
No color or no rows: the check may not apply; it does not mean it passed.

The **Difference** column shows zero where the compared values agree. **Sum of group values** is compared with the **Reference total**; in column percentage checks, **Sum of percentages** is compared with 100. **Worksheet row** and **Worksheet column** identify positions in the tabulation plan.

Ready to continue: the applicable checks pass, or you have explained and documented any expected differences. Also check that the table's population, labels, statistics, and interpretation match its purpose; matching totals alone do not establish that.

8. Save the reviewed table to Excel

Use **Write to Excel** when you want to keep or share tables in workbook form.

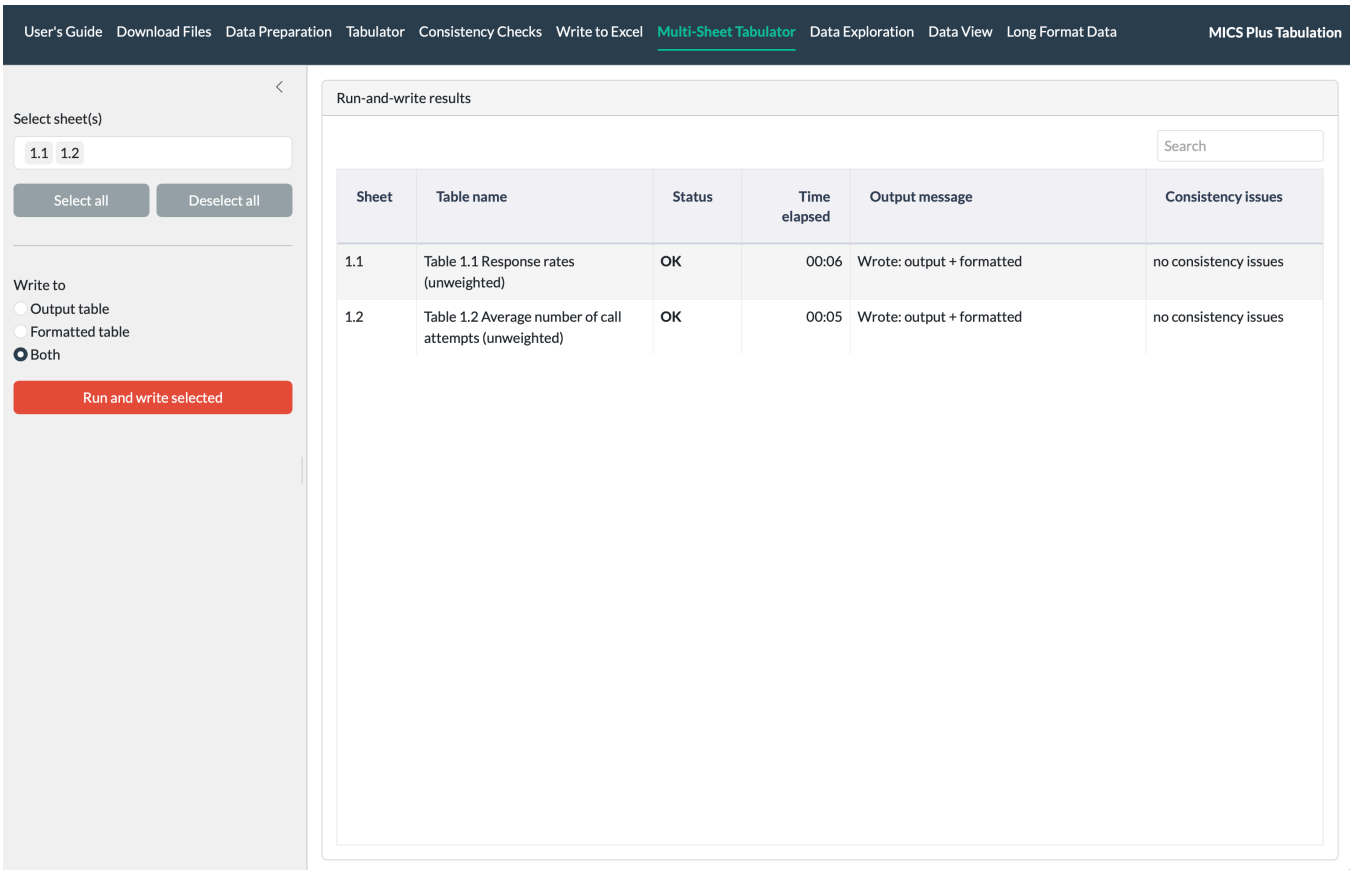


1. Click **Write to Excel**. Under **Create**, choose **Both** to create the Output and Formatted workbooks, or select the single workbook type you need.
2. Click **Create Excel File(s) once for this run**. Two file paths appear on the right. This creates workbook copies; it does not fill every table.
3. Click **Write to Output Table**. Wait for the write to finish.
4. Click **Write to Formatted Table**. Wait again. Both buttons write the **current table** to its matching sheet.
5. Under **Formatted file path**, click **Open folder** to find the saved file, or **Open file** to view it. Check the expected sheet in Excel.

Output keeps numeric values for review along with the unweighted denominators where available. **Formatted** contains the table's presentation values and applicable notes. Close the workbook in Excel before writing another table. If **Open folder** does not work, copy the displayed folder path into File Explorer or Finder.

Next table: repeat **Tabulator > Run**, **Consistency Checks > Run Checks**, then the two **Write** buttons. Reuse the same workbooks; do not click **Create Excel File(s)** again for every table.

9. Run several tables together



Prepare the data, then use **Multi-Sheet Tabulator** to calculate and write selected tables together.

1. Click **Multi-Sheet Tabulator**. Click **Select sheet(s)** and choose a table. Click again to add another. Use **Deselect all** to clear the selection.
2. Under **Write to**, choose **Output**, **Formatted**, or **Both**.
3. Click **Run and write selected** once. The app automatically creates the required workbook for any output type whose destination has not yet been created or selected. Keep your R environment and the browser open until it finishes.
4. When the completion message appears, click **OK**. Read every row in **Run-and-write results**, especially **status**, **message**, and **Consistency issues**. Use the horizontal scrollbar if a column is off the right edge.

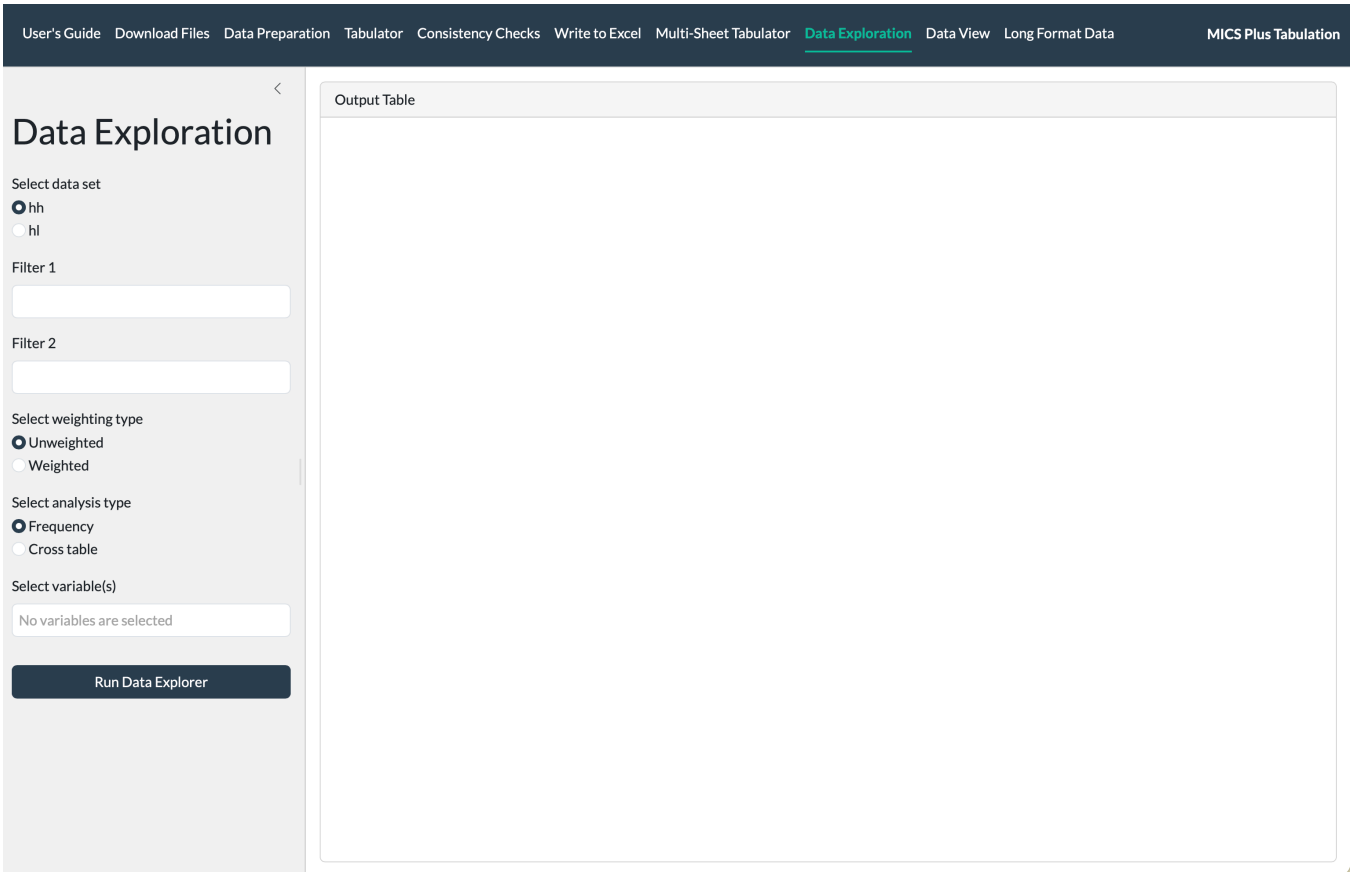
Where the tables are saved: if you have already created or selected workbooks in **Write to Excel**, this run writes to those destinations. Otherwise, it creates workbooks from the uploaded tabulation plan in the app's **Excel output folder**, normally `micsPlusTableR-output` in your survey project. Open **Write to Excel** to see the file paths and use **Open file** or **Open folder**. You do not need to click **Create Excel File(s)** before a multi-sheet run.

To continue work in an existing workbook, select it with the matching **Choose existing...** button in **Write to Excel** before starting the run. The app does not automatically find previously saved workbooks.

Ready to continue: every requested table has completed and its results have been reviewed. This action writes tables as it runs; it does not wait for your review of each table.

If a table fails or has consistency issues, note its code and message. Investigate the error or difference before using the result. Start with a few tables; use **Select all** when ready for the full run.

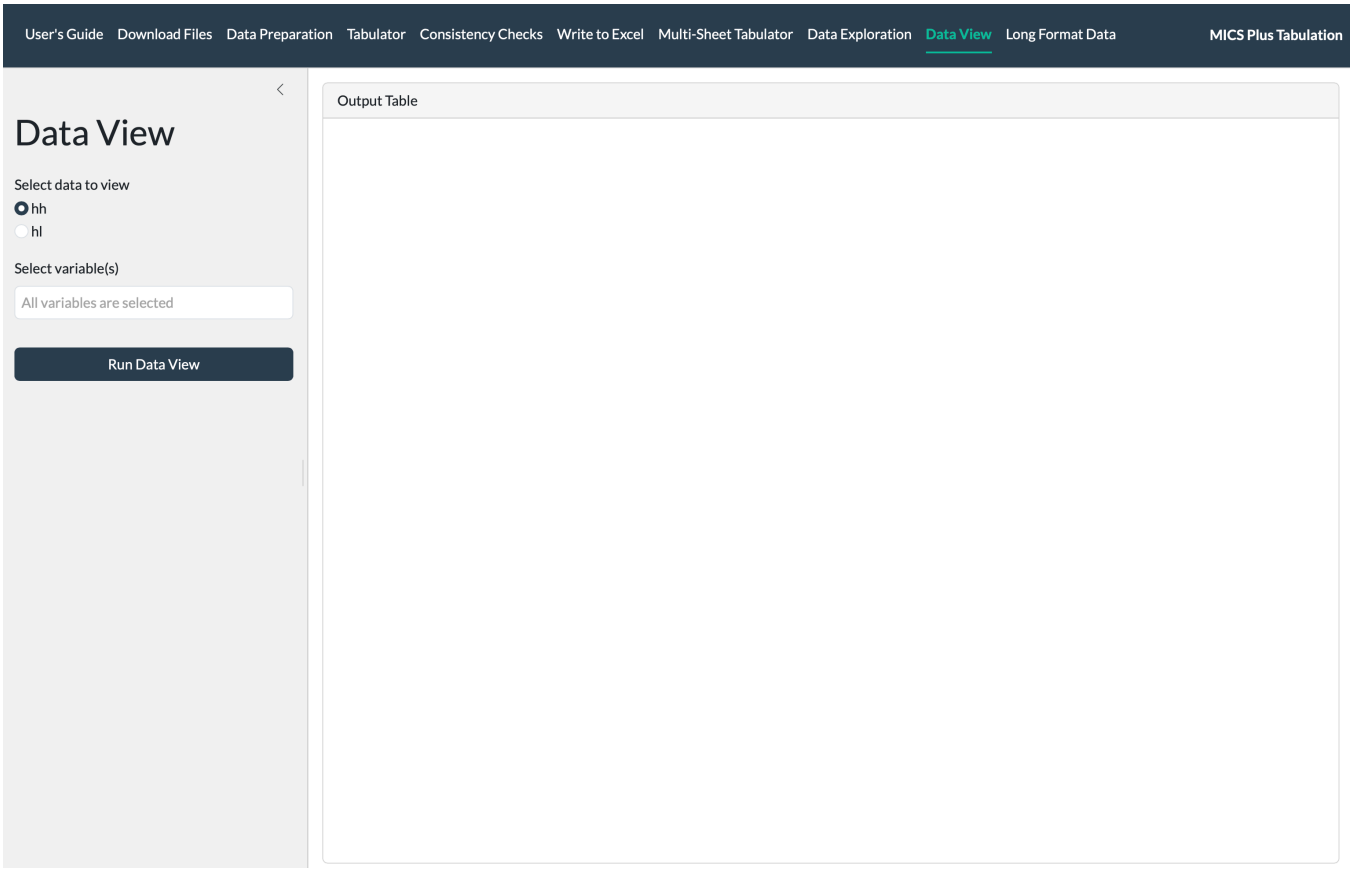
10. Explore a question



Data Exploration lets you investigate questions through frequencies and cross-tabulations without changing the tabulation plan. Use it to understand the data, examine relationships, or investigate a result. These analyses are separate from the tables defined in the plan.

1. After **Data Preparation**, click **Data Exploration**.
2. Under **Select data set**, choose **hh** for households or **hl** for household members. Under **Select variable(s)**, choose the variables relevant to your question.
3. Choose **Unweighted** or **Weighted** for the analysis you intend. If weighted, enter the appropriate survey weight in **Type weight variable**. Check the preparation script or survey documentation if you are unsure which weight to use.
4. Choose **Frequency** to count categories of one variable, or **Cross table** to get a cross table of two variables. Select the second variable if needed.
5. Leave the filter box blank for all prepared records, or enter the condition for the population you want to examine. Use filter function to define the condition. Click **Run Data Explorer** and read the result.

11. Look at prepared data



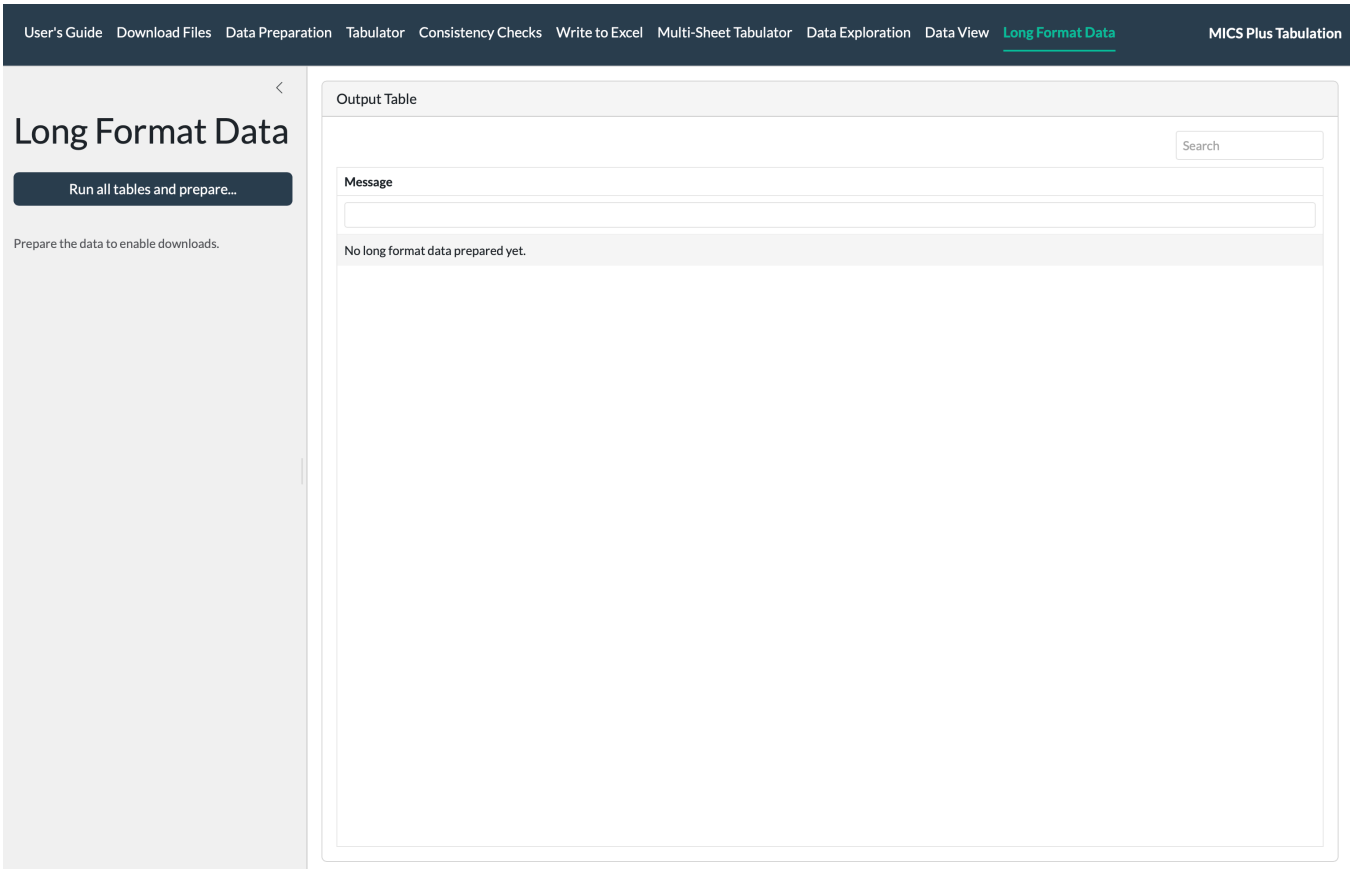
Data View shows data after preparation. Use it to inspect variable values and labels, understand the prepared dataset, or investigate a table result. A **variable** is a named item in the data, like age or region.

1. Complete **Data Preparation**, then click **Data View**.
2. Under **Select data to view**, choose **hh** for households or **hl** for household members.
3. Select the variables you want to inspect.
4. Click **Run Data View**. Read the preview and its labels.

Check: you are looking at the intended dataset and variables. This screen may show individual survey records.

You can return to **Tabulator** by clicking its tab at the top. Viewing data here does not save a presentation table to Excel. The picture shows the controls before any individual records are displayed.

12. Download a data file



Use **Long Format Data** when you need calculated table cells together in one dataset for analysis, exchange, or further processing. This produces a combined data layout; **Write to Excel** saves tables in their worksheet layouts. Choose the output that serves your purpose.

1. Complete **Data Preparation** first.
2. Click **Long Format Data**.
3. Click **Run all tables and prepare...**. Wait while the application calculates the tables. This may take longer than running one table.
4. When the data preview appears without an error, find **Download output** in the left panel. Click **Excel (.xlsx)** for a spreadsheet, or the format you require.
5. Find the file in your browser's **Downloads** list or your computer's **Downloads** folder. Some browsers ask you to choose a save location.

What you receive: one combined file of calculated table cells. It is a different layout from the **Formatted** workbook. **CSV (.csv)** is a plain text table; **RDS (.rds)** is mostly for someone working in R.

The download contains all prepared rows, including rows hidden by preview filters or pages. Check the country, period, and wave in the filename before sending it. If a table fails, inspect its error message, correct the relevant input or instruction, and rerun before relying on the download.

13. Finish, return later, or get help

Finish your work

1. If you need to retain results, write tables to Excel or download combined table data. If viewing results was sufficient, no export is needed.
2. If you saved files, open them and check the country, wave, and expected contents. Keep any review notes with them.
3. Close any open workbooks, then close the application's browser tab.
4. In RStudio, click the red **Stop** button in the Console to stop the app. In another editor, use its R session interrupt/stop control. You may then close the editor. Saving an R workspace is not a substitute for saving the Excel workbooks.

When you return: reopen the same survey project, run `micsPlusTableR::run_app()`, and select your inputs again. The app does not automatically restore the previous browser session. For a fresh single-table export, create workbooks in **Write to Excel** first. **Multi-Sheet Tabulator** creates them automatically when you run it if no destinations have been set. To continue an existing workbook, select it using the **Choose existing...** buttons in **Write to Excel** before writing. Writing the same sheet again replaces its previously written values.

If something goes wrong

What you see	What to do next
Download list unavailable	Check internet access and that the files repository is public, then click **Load / refresh surveys**.
Download says files already exist	Choose another download folder, or deliberately enable **Replace existing files**.
Missing file or wrong filename	Return to **Data Preparation**, select the correct file, and click **Set** again. Rerun and recheck the table.
Country or wave mismatch	Compare the dropdown choices with the IDX sheet and the country, period, and wave of your input files. Select a matching set.
Preparation error or missing variable	Check the named variable, selected data source, and preparation step. If the script needs a change you cannot make, provide its maintainer with the complete error message.
No calculated table in Tabulator	Check that **Set** completed, choose a sheet, and click **Run**.
Workbook preview alone is blank or says Preview failed	Check your connection and whether **cdn.jsdelivr.net** is blocked. A cached library is not guaranteed; see workbook preview and caching. You can inspect the plan in Excel and continue tabulating. Save your results before restarting the app to retry.
Red consistency tab	Inspect the displayed differences and the related groups, filters, and denominators. Correct errors or document expected differences before using the result.
Excel file cannot be written	Close that workbook in Excel, then try its **Write** button again.
Cannot find the saved workbook	Use **Write to Excel > Open folder** or the path shown there. For a data download, check **Downloads** instead.
Browser disconnected or refreshed	Save any work still available. Restart the app if needed and select the inputs again; check existing files before rewriting.

When asking for help, include: country and wave, table code, the button you clicked, and the exact error text. A screenshot of the message helps; leave individual survey records out of it. Your IT support can check the installed package version in RStudio.

Read a calculation error

Calculation errors now identify the worksheet and, where available, the filter block, Excel row and column, statistic, and condition that failed. For example:

```
Worksheet 'Example', horizontal block 2, starting column 4 ...
Excel row 9, column 4; column condition: age >= 18; statistic: p
object 'age' not found
```

Here, `age` is missing from the prepared data used for that block. The row and column refer to positions in the tabulation plan. A block is a group of columns that share a filter. An index alone (such as "In index: 1") does not explain the cause; keep the complete message, including the expression and the final cause.

- **Prepared data source unavailable:** confirm that data preparation finished and that the plan names the correct household or household-member file.
- **Weight column not found or not numeric:** check the plan's "weight by" entry against the prepared data. Confirm that the named variable exists and contains numeric weights.
- **Unknown variable or invalid expression:** use the reported cell position to check the condition's variable names and R syntax against the prepared data.
- **Unsupported statistic:** the statistic cell contains a code that this direction of tabulation does not support. Use a statistic supported by that direction and appropriate to the intended calculation.
- **No data-source condition in B4:B7:** check that the selected worksheet is a table plan and contains its source/filter instructions in the expected cells.
- **Extra-table dimensions differ:** the preparation script's supplied table must match the plan's row count, with one label column and the value columns.
- **Comparison row or column counts differ:** align the two tables and check skipped header rows before comparing again.

After correcting the input, repeat data preparation if the script changed, then calculate and check the table again.

Understand the tabulation plan

The tabulation plan (Excel) describes the tables the app will calculate and provides their output layout. This reference is for anyone who wants to understand how a table is created, as well as people creating or adapting plans. You can inspect these instructions without editing them.

What the tabulation plan contains

The workbook contains survey information and a table index in **IDX**, plus worksheets for individual tables. A table worksheet brings together these parts:

Part	Where to look and what it tells you
Table title and column headings	At the top of the worksheet: what the table and each column describe.
Row labels and groups	In column A: the categories shown in the output. Indentation marks nested groups.
Dataset, filters, and weight	In the instruction row near the top: the source population and weight used in calculations.
Row and column conditions	In column B beside the rows, and in the instruction row above the result columns: which groups and outcomes each cell represents.
Statistics	In the table body, from column C onward: whether a cell calculates a count, percentage, mean, or another supported statistic.
Display and supporting instructions	Decimal settings, unweighted bases, notes, and worksheet formatting help determine how results are displayed and checked.

The following sections follow the calculation instructions: identify the dataset, understand the filters, then read the conditions and statistics. The headings describe the results; the instructions determine the values.

Find the dataset name

Look in **column B, rows 4 to 7** for the cell containing a name ending in `.sav`, such as `hh.sav` or `hl.sav`. The app uses that cell's row as the worksheet's **condition row**, where column-level instructions are recorded. Its position can vary with the number of heading rows.

The name before `.sav` identifies the prepared dataset used for the table: `hh.sav` selects `hh`, and `hl.sav` selects `hl`. These refer to data available after **Data Preparation**; the app does not open a new file from disk each time it encounters the name. The preparation script must provide the matching dataset and variables.

A source cell may contain several lines, for example:

```
hh.sav
filter(age >= 18)
weight by w
```

Here, `hh` is the dataset, the filter restricts the population to adults, and `w` is the weight variable. The names are illustrative; read the actual names in your plan. In a horizontal table, a later instruction block may specify a different dataset. A blank source or weight entry inherits the preceding setting, so check earlier instruction cells too.

Understand worksheet filters

A `filter(...)` instruction restricts the records available for the calculation. Find it in column B or a later column of the condition row identified above. These are worksheet instructions, separate from the app's search boxes and from the row and column conditions explained below.

The statistic written in a result cell is called `stat_type`. Examples include `p` for a percentage, `n` for a weighted count, `n_unw` for an unweighted count, and the mean types `mean` and `mean(variable)`.

Column B is global. A filter such as `filter(age >= 18)` in B limits the whole table to adults. It remains active when another filter starts, when the statistic changes, and when a new table row begins. A later filter cannot bring excluded records back into the table.

Additional filters apply to horizontal blocks. In a horizontal table, a `filter(...)` in C or a later column combines with B. It applies to its own column and extends to the right. Its position relative to B makes no difference: it always combines with B. For example, changes from `p` to `n` or `n_unw` keep the filter, so percentages and their counts use the same population.

There are two ways an additional filter stops:

- **Another explicit filter starts.** The new `filter(...)` replaces the previous additional filter and combines with B, starting at its own column.
- **An `unfilter()` instruction appears.** Write `unfilter()` in the condition row in place of `filter(...)`. That column and following columns use B alone until a new explicit filter starts. Row and column predicates still apply.

All statistic changes preserve the active filter, including changes from counts or percentages to means, between mean variables, and back to counts.

Blank filter cells do not cancel an active filter. Use `unfilter()` to remove an additional restriction explicitly; B still applies. For a column with its own predicate, write for example:

```
unfilter()
- - -
total == 1
```

How to recognize the table direction. The reader selects horizontal mode when the plan has `n_unw` immediately before `IDX`, or a `100/100.0` statistic. Other plans use vertical mode. In vertical tables, the first filter in B still restricts the common dataset; additional horizontal filter blocks are not processed.

Filter example: follow one row from left to right

Suppose B contains `filter(age >= 18)`. In one horizontal table row, the instructions are:

Column	Statistic	Filter instruction here	Records available to this cell
C	`p`	None	All adults
D	`p`	`filter(sex == 2)`	Adults with sex code 2
E	`n`	None	Adults with sex code 2
F	`n_unw`	None	Adults with sex code 2
G	`mean`	None	Adults with sex code 2
H	`n`	`unfilter()`	All adults
I	`mean`	`filter(region == 1)`	Adults in region 1
J	`mean(age)`	None	Adults in region 1
K	`n_unw`	None	Adults in region 1

No cell includes people under 18. D's filter applies to D-G, including the percentage, its counts, and the mean. It stops at H's `unfilter()`. I starts a new filter, which applies to I-K, including the change from `mean` to `mean(age)`, and does not include D's sex restriction. Other row and column conditions still determine what is measured within these populations.

Statistic changes do not stop filters. A blank statistic cell also preserves the filter. Only a new `filter(...)` or `unfilter()` ends the previous additional filter's scope.

When filters run. For each required population, the engine loads the selected source, applies B, applies any active additional filter, and then runs the block's calculations. It calculates cell values from that data. The filters therefore affect both the numerator and denominator of a percentage. A filter variable must already exist before those calculations.

Within each filter block, calculations run in column order. A `mutate(...)` instruction, which creates a new variable, applies to its own column and later columns; a later recode does not change earlier cells. Column B's calculation runs once per block. A calculation-only instruction does not end the filter's column range.

Filters do not reach left. Adding a filter in G does not change F's calculated mean. Display suppression still needs an unweighted count: if a new filter separates a cell from its count, the engine uses the next `n_unw` to its right on the same row and data source when no count is already linked. Existing count links and the small-sample thresholds remain in effect.

Define row and column conditions for your output

Conditions connect the labels in your table to the records used in each result. Prepare them by deciding **who the result describes, what you want to measure, and which groups you want to compare**. A heading such as "Urban", "Total", or "Number of household members" does not select records or change the calculation by itself.

Start with the intended population and result

1. **Choose the unit.** Are you describing households, individual members, or people living in households with a particular characteristic? Use the matching prepared dataset and weight. The member-count convention described below lets a household table count the people represented by its household records.
2. **Set eligibility with filters.** Apply the table-wide eligibility rule in B, and any additional population restrictions in the relevant horizontal block. For example, a table about healthcare users might include only households reporting that a member received care.
3. **Decide which groups and outcomes belong on each axis.** In a horizontal percentage table, rows select comparison groups and columns select outcomes. In a vertical percentage table, columns select comparison groups and rows select outcomes.
4. **Choose the statistic and its base.** Use `p` for a weighted percentage, `n` for a weighted count, `n_unw` for an unweighted base, or `mean(variable)` for a numeric average. Conditions select records; the statistic determines the calculation.

The worksheet layout determines the calculation direction. An `n_unw` statistic immediately before the `IDX` column, or a constant `100` statistic in the table, selects horizontal mode; otherwise the reader selects vertical mode. Start from a working plan with the required direction and retain its base-count and `IDX` structure. Merely moving headings between rows and columns does not transpose the calculation.

Write the conditions in the correct cells

Put **row conditions in column B**, below the condition row and beside their labels in column A. Use `total == 1` beside the overall Total row, then conditions such as `area == 1` for Urban and `area == 2` for Rural, if these are the survey's codes. Keep group-heading or separator rows without a calculation condition. A blank row-condition cell is not a request to calculate an unrestricted total.

Put **column conditions in C onward on the condition row**, below the column headings. A column for households reporting healthcare expenses might use `HCS7 == 1`. A column for all eligible households in the same block uses `total == 1`. The preparation script must supply the named variables; check their codes in **Data View** before using them.

Write logical expressions as plain cell text, without an Excel `=` prefix. Names and letter case must match the prepared data. Numeric codes use numbers; text values use quotes. These examples are patterns to adapt to your survey:

Intended selection	Condition
One category	`area == 1`
Either of two response codes	`response %in% c(1, 2)`
Age 15 through 49	`age >= 15 & age <= 49`
Urban households meeting an outcome	`area == 1 & HCS7 == 1`
A text category	`status == "Complete"`
A recorded numeric value	`!is.na(expense)`

Use `==` for equality, `!=` for inequality, `&` for both conditions, and `|` for either condition. For example, `(HCS7 == 1) | (HCS9 == 1)` selects records meeting either criterion. Use parentheses to make combinations clear. Avoid `&&` and `||`, which do not express record-by-record selection. Unknown-response codes such as 98 or 99 are ordinary values unless the preparation script recodes them. Explicitly decide whether they belong in the base. Excluding them only from the outcome is different from excluding them with a filter.

A combined instruction cell can place the filter above a separator and the column condition below it:

```
filter(HCS7 %in% c(1, 2))
- - -
HCS7 == 1
```

This restricts the block to the listed response codes, then measures code 1 within that base. Write setup instructions above `- - -` and the complete column condition below it. The condition can span multiple lines. A blank column instruction can inherit the preceding instruction, so write changed conditions explicitly. See worksheet filters for how far an additional filter extends.

You can create a variable for the conditions with `mutate(...)`:

```
mutate(WS1R = if_else(WS1 %in% c(11, 12), 1, 0))
- - -
WS1R == 1 &
between(WS4, 1, 30)
```

Within a horizontal filter block, mutations run left to right; later redefinitions leave earlier results unchanged. Multiple and multiline calls are supported. Filters run first, so create variables needed by filters or across blocks in the preparation script. Mutations use temporary data and do not change prepared `hh`/`hl`.

In row-condition cells in column B, both table directions apply mutations top to bottom, before each row's condition. Variables remain available to following rows; later redefinitions leave earlier results unchanged. Repeated mutations run again. Mutation-only cells mean `TRUE`, and setup also runs on rows without a statistic. Row conditions do not restrict subsequent rows.

Use total conditions for the correct base

The maintained preparation scripts create `total = 1` in both `hh` and `hl`. Thus `total == 1` includes every record still eligible after the applicable filters. In a horizontal table it also remains subject to the row condition: an Urban row still counts only urban records.

Condition written in a column instruction	Purpose
`total == 1`	Include all eligible records for that row and block. With `n`, sum their weights; with `n_unw`, count their records.
`total1 == 1` through `total5 == 1`	Numbered aliases for `total == 1`, used for repeated total/base columns in different blocks. The number does not select a subgroup.
`totalHL == 1`, or `totalHL1 == 1` through `totalHL4 == 1`	Aliases for the special `hhmembers` condition. In a horizontal `n_unw` cell, sum household sizes rather than count household records.
`hhmembers`	The member-count condition itself; this is also the form shown after the plan reader converts a `totalHL` alias.

Why use `total1`? Suppose the first block describes all eligible households and a later block describes only households with healthcare expenses. The first block may use `total == 1` for its count columns; the later block may use `total1 == 1`. Both are evaluated as `total == 1`. The later block's filter creates its different base. Changing the suffix alone does not create that base or change weights. You do not need a variable called `total1` in the data for this column alias.

These aliases are recognized by the **worksheet column reader**. Write the complete forms exactly as shown, including `== 1` and its spacing; `total1` alone is not the alias. Use `total == 1` for an ordinary Total row. Numbered names in row conditions or inside `filter(...)` are not converted and would require real variables with those names. Likewise, do not combine an alias into `total1 == 1 & area == 1`; place the group restriction in the row condition or a filter and keep the column alias on its own. Higher suffixes are not automatically supported.

`TRUE` is an unrestricted logical condition, but use `total == 1` for ordinary totals in a plan: consistency checks also recognize the total condition. Some supplied extra-table layouts use `ph` as a placeholder for results calculated by their matching preparation script. Keep those layouts with their script; `ph` does not define a survey outcome.

The visible word "Total", a total condition, and the statistic `100` have different functions. A total condition selects records. A percentage with `total == 1` measures all eligible records and normally returns 100 when the base is nonempty. The statistic `100` supplies a constant for a distribution-total column; it does not count records.

Count household members from household records

Use the `totalHL == 1` convention when the source is **one record per household** and the output needs the **unweighted number of people living in those households**. For a horizontal column, write:

- **Column condition:** `totalHL == 1` (converted to `hhmembers`).
- **Statistic below it:** `n_unw`.
- **Required prepared variables:** `total`, equal to 1 for included households, and numeric `HLnum`, the number of members in each household.

After the filters and row condition, this sums `HLnum` for households with `total == 1`, ignoring missing contributions. For two qualifying households of sizes 2 and 4, the result is **6 members**. An ordinary `total == 1` / `n_unw` cell gives **2 households**. Verify that `HLnum` is complete and matches the intended member definition; missing sizes would understate the member base.

Weighted member estimates need a member-based weight as well. The `totalHL` alias does not change weights. In a household-level analysis of people living in those households, the supplied plans use a weight such as household weight multiplied by household size. For example, Mongolia Wave 1 table 5.1 uses this instruction in B6:

```
hh.sav
mutate(hhmemwt = hhweightA*HLnum)
filter(HH17 %in% c(0,1))
weight by hhmemwt
```

Its weighted member-count column uses `total == 1` with `n`; its unweighted member-count column uses `totalHL == 1` with `n_unw`. Its `p` cells use `hhmemwt` to estimate the share of people living in households with each characteristic. Use the household weight approved for your survey; `hhweightA` is the name in this example plan.

For an illustration, let the two household sizes be 2 and 4, with household weights 1 and 3. The ordinary weighted household count is $\mathbf{1 + 3 = 4}$. The weighted member count is $\mathbf{1 \times 2 + 3 \times 4 = 14}$; the unweighted member base remains $\mathbf{2 + 4 = 6}$. If only the first household meets an outcome, its share is **25% of households** but about **14.3% of members**. Choose the weight to match the output's unit, and label both estimates and bases accordingly.

Use the convention only for its supported calculation. It is special handling for horizontal `n_unw` (also the existing `n_unw1` variant), not a general condition for `n`, `p`, means, or vertical tables. On an `hl` dataset with one record per member, use ordinary conditions and `n_unw` to count qualifying members. Summing `HLnum` again on member records would repeat household sizes and overcount. To count a subset of members, such as children under five, use the member dataset and the relevant age condition; `hhmembers` always sums the supplied household size and does not inspect individual ages.

Build a horizontal table around the intended output

Suppose your prepared `hh` data have `total = 1`, `area`, `HCS7` (1 = healthcare expenses reported, 2 = no expenses), and `HCS8` (expense amount). First select the eligible households with the table's global filter and choose its household weight. Use `total == 1` for the Total row, `area == 1` for Urban, and `area == 2` for Rural.

For a percentage and its base, prepare these columns:

Output heading	Column condition	Statistic
Percentage reporting expenses	`HCS7 == 1`	`p`
Weighted number of eligible households	`total == 1`	`n`
Unweighted number of eligible households	`total == 1`	`n_unw`

The percentage denominator includes all eligible households in the row. Changing the count columns to `HCS7 == 1` would count households reporting expenses instead; it would not change the percentage's denominator. Keep the base counts aligned with the population described by the percentage and with the intended suppression base.

For average expenses **among households reporting expenses with a valid amount**, start another block with this instruction:

```
filter(HCS7 == 1 & HCS8 < 9999998)
- - -
total1 == 1
```

Use `mean(HCS8)` in that first result column, followed by columns with condition `total1 == 1` and statistics `n` and `n_unw`. Those count columns describe the same filtered population as the mean. This follows the pattern in Mongolia Wave 2 table 6.2a. Its threshold excludes that survey's special amount codes; substitute the valid range for your survey. Put the filter on the mean column itself to start this restricted population there. It continues until a new filter or `unfilter()` appears.

An average **across all eligible households**, including those with no expenses, is a different output. It needs an appropriately prepared amount variable with true no-expense values coded as zero and a base that includes those households. Do not obtain it by treating unknown amounts as zero or by retaining the expense-only filter.

Prepare a vertical distribution and check the result

For a vertical distribution of households by area, put `area == 1` and `area == 2` in the row conditions. A column condition `total == 1` defines all eligible households; another column condition `HCS7 == 1` defines households reporting expenses. Use `p` for the category cells. Each column's denominator is its own eligible population, so its area categories can sum to 100 when they cover all records without overlap. Retain the vertical layout of the source plan; adding the horizontal `n_unw/IDX` arrangement changes direction.

For an explicit first Total row, use row condition `total == 1`. Existing vertical plans may use `p(100)` to set the first calculated row to 100; see statistic types before adapting that convention. Keep group-heading rows separate from calculated rows.

Before using a new or changed plan:

1. Read one result aloud as "[statistic] of [outcome] among [base], grouped by [row/column characteristic]." Check that the dataset, filters, conditions, and weight implement that sentence.
2. Check the Total row and one subgroup in **Tabulator**, using **Header**, **Index**, and **Logic** to match labels to instructions. Seeing `total == 1` in place of `total1 == 1`, or `hhmembers` in place of `totalHL == 1`, is expected after alias conversion.
3. Confirm whether each count represents household records, member records, or summed household sizes, and whether it is weighted. Inspect the unformatted base before interpreting suppression.
4. For a distribution, make categories exhaustive and non-overlapping, with an explicit decision about missing responses. Overlapping multiple-response outcomes need not sum to 100.
5. Save and upload the plan again, rerun the affected tables, and review **Consistency Checks**. Checks can reveal discrepancies; they cannot decide whether you chose the intended population or unit.

Understand statistic types (`stat_type`)

A **statistic type** tells the app what to calculate in a result cell. It is written in the worksheet body, from column C onward, below the condition row. For example, `n`, `p`, and `mean(HCS8)` request different calculations even when their row and column conditions are identical. The app calls this instruction `stat_type`.

Each instruction applies to its own row-and-column intersection. The worksheet reader fills blank statistic cells from preceding instructions; a blank cell does not necessarily mean "skip this cell" or "show zero." Read the applicable statistic together with the dataset, filters, weight, and row and column conditions.

Which records does a statistic use?

The dataset and active `filter(...)` instructions first determine which records are available. The table's direction then determines the base population and the outcome being counted:

Table direction	Base population for a percentage	Outcome counted in the numerator
Horizontal	Available records satisfying the row condition.	Records within that base satisfying the column condition.
Vertical	Available records satisfying the column condition.	Records within that base satisfying the row condition.

Counts use records satisfying **both** conditions. Numeric means and medians also use both conditions, then summarize the named variable. They do not summarize the already calculated cells of the output table.

A **weighted count** sums the specified weight for qualifying records. An **unweighted count** counts the actual qualifying records. A weighted percentage is **100 × weighted outcome count / weighted base count**. The denominator comes from the applicable population; it is not read from a neighbouring `n` cell. A neighbouring count describes that base only if its instructions select the same population.

Counts and percentages

The directions in the final column refer to the calculation modes explained under worksheet filters.

Write in the cell	What it calculates and applies to	Direction
`n`	Sum of weights for records satisfying both row and column conditions. Use for a weighted number of households, members, or other units in the selected dataset.	Both
`n_unw`	Number of qualifying records, without survey weights. Also supplies sample-size bases used by supported suppression rules.	Both
`p`	Weighted percentage meeting the outcome condition within the base population defined above. The result is on a 0-100 scale.	Both
`p_unw`	Unweighted percentage meeting the row condition among records selected by the column condition.	Vertical

Write in the cell	What it calculates and applies to	Direction
`mean`	The same weighted indicator-percentage calculation as `p`, on a 0-100 scale. It does not average an unnamed numeric variable. It is treated as a mean for filter inheritance.	Both
`mean_unw`	Unweighted indicator percentage, on a 0-100 scale. The outcome is the column condition in horizontal tables and the row condition in vertical tables.	Both

For a horizontal `n_unw` column using `totalHL == 1` (converted to `hhmembers`), the app sums `HLnum` for qualifying household records with `total == 1`. This gives a member count rather than a household-record count. See household-member bases for the paired weighted count, required variables, and limits of this convention.

Numeric means and medians

Here, `variable` is a numeric variable in the prepared dataset, such as `HCS8` or `age`. Its name must appear inside the parentheses.

Write in the cell	What it calculates and applies to	Direction
`mean(variable)`	Weighted average of the named variable among records satisfying both conditions: sum of value × weight divided by sum of weights for non-missing values.	Both
`mean_unw(variable)`	Ordinary arithmetic average of the named variable among records satisfying both conditions, without survey weights.	Both
`median(variable)`	Unweighted median of the named variable among records satisfying both conditions. It is the middle value after sorting, or the average of the two middle values.	Both
`median_unw(variable)`	Explicit unweighted median; the same calculation as `median(variable)`.	Vertical
`mean(newvar = expression)`	Creates the named variable from the expression, then calculates its weighted mean for the records satisfying both conditions. For example, `mean(expense = HCS8 / 1000)` expresses average expenses in thousands.	Vertical

Missing values of the summarized variable are excluded from numeric means and medians. A numeric code for "unknown" or "not applicable" is not automatically missing: exclude such codes through the preparation script, filters, or applicable conditions. `median(variable)` remains unweighted even when the plan specifies a weight.

Worked example: the same data, different statistics

Suppose a horizontal table's filters and row condition leave three records. Their weights are **1, 2, and 1**. The first two satisfy the column condition `HCS7 == 1`; their `HCS8` values are **100 and 200**.

Statistic	Calculation	Result
`n`	Qualifying weights: 1 + 2	3
`n_unw`	Two qualifying records	2
`p` or bare `mean`	100 × (1 + 2) / (1 + 2 + 1)	75
Bare `mean_unw`	100 × 2 / 3	About 66.7
`mean(HCS8)`	(100 × 1 + 200 × 2) / (1 + 2)	About 166.7
`mean_unw(HCS8)`	(100 + 200) / 2	150
`median(HCS8)`	Middle of 100 and 200	150

These are illustrative calculations. In a vertical table, the column condition selects the base and the row condition identifies the outcome.

Totals, special forms, and existing-plan variants

These instructions have specific roles. Use their stated direction; adding a decimal argument does not make an unsupported form available in another direction.

Instruction	Meaning and where it applies
`100` or `100.0`	Supplies a constant 100, rather than estimating a percentage from records. In a worksheet, its presence selects horizontal mode and can mark a percentage-distribution total. Existing zero-base and suppression rules may alter its displayed value.
`p(100)`	Vertical: supplies 100 on the first calculated row; subsequent rows calculate weighted percentages as `p`. Used for a distribution with a 100-percent total.
`p_unw(100)`	Vertical: supplies 100 on the first calculated row; subsequent rows calculate unweighted percentages as `p_unw`.
`n_unw(100)`	Vertical: supplies 100 on the first calculated row; subsequent rows calculate unweighted counts. It does not turn those counts into percentages.
`n(100)`	The current vertical calculator recognizes this only on the first calculated row and returns 100. Use `n` for later weighted-count rows; repeating `n(100)` there is unsupported.
`p_sum(variable)`	Horizontal: among records satisfying both conditions, calculates **100 × sum(variable) / sum(weight)**. It does not multiply the numerator variable by the weight. Use only with a prepared variable whose definition makes this calculation appropriate.
`n1`, `n_unw1`, `p1`	Calculate like `n`, `n_unw`, and `p`, respectively, in both directions. These are existing-plan variants, not requests for one decimal place. They intend to distinguish columns to be included in a consistency check group.
`n2`, `n_unw2`	Vertical count variants, calculated like `n` and `n_unw`. The suffix is not a decimal setting.
Legacy `Mean`	Capitalized form for an unweighted condition-based percentage. Prefer the explicit `mean_unw` spelling when interpreting or adapting this calculation. Lowercase `mean` uses weights.

The `(100)` forms refer to the **first calculated row**, not any row whose visible label happens to say "Total". Their later-row behavior is shown above. They are not supported by the horizontal calculator.

Use the ordinary `n`, `n_unw`, and `p` forms unless an existing plan needs its variants. Equal count calculations do not imply identical handling elsewhere: automatic direction, count linkage, suppression, and checks can depend on the exact statistic name and its worksheet position.

Missing conditions and denominators. A record must satisfy a condition to count toward its outcome. In weighted `p` and bare `mean`, a missing outcome condition does not contribute to the numerator, but its available weight remains in the base denominator. Horizontal unweighted indicator percentages count missing outcomes as false; vertical unweighted indicator percentages omit missing outcome indicators from their denominator. If unknown responses should be excluded from the base, define that population explicitly in the plan.

Display precision. Any supported statistic can include `d=` to control displayed decimal places: `n(d=0)`, `p(d=2)`, `mean(d=1)`, `mean(HCS8, d=0)`, or `p(100, d=2)`. This does not change the underlying calculation. See Choose decimal places for the full display rules.

Use **Header**, **Index**, and **Logic** in Tabulator to relate results to their labels, worksheet positions, and conditions. After editing a plan, save and upload it again, then rerun the affected tables and checks.

Choose decimal places in the worksheet

Read `d=` to understand a result's displayed precision. When editing a plan, add **`d=` inside a statistic's parentheses** to choose how many decimal places are shown. This is available for every supported statistic type. If the statistic already has an argument, add a comma before `d=`.

What you want	What to write in the statistic cell	Example display
Whole-number average expenses in table 6.2a	`mean(HCS8, d=0)`	`442,572`
Average expenses with two decimals	`mean(HCS8, d=2)`	`442,571.91`
Mean indicator with one decimal	`mean(d=1)`	`73.3`
Percentage with two decimals	`p(d=2)`	`73.30`
Count with one decimal	`n(d=1)`	`881.0`
Unweighted count with no decimals	`n_unw(d=0)`	`622`
Median with two decimals	`median(age, d=2)`	`35.00`
Total/distribution statistic with two decimals	`p(100, d=2)`	`100.00`

These numbers illustrate the display, not survey results. The same rule works with other supported statistics, including `mean_unw`, legacy `Mean`, and `p_sum`. A constant can be written as `100(d=2)`. Keep the statistic appropriate to the table's direction and intended calculation.

If you leave out `d`, nothing changes: the app keeps its established formatting for that statistic and output mode. Means default to one decimal place. For example, `mean(HCS8)` still displays `442,571.9`.

Use a whole number of decimal places. `d=0` removes the decimal point; `d=1`, `d=2`, and `d=3` show one, two, and three decimal places, including trailing zeros. Spaces are allowed, so `mean(HCS8, d=0)` is valid. Give `d` only once, as a non-negative whole number, without quotation marks or a calculation. For example, `d=-1`, `d=1.5`, and `d="2"` are invalid.

Where it applies. The Formatted and Suppressed Tabulator views use the requested decimals for visible numbers. The Unformatted view retains the full numeric estimate. Both Excel output workbooks use the requested number format, including workbooks written by Multi-sheet Tabulator and values supplied by preparation scripts. Thousands separators remain in the Formatted preview and Excel. Long Format Data records the setting in `DECIMALS` and display values; `OBS_VALUE` retains full precision.

What stays the same. Display rounding does not change the calculated number, weights, filters, denominators, or consistency checks. Excel keeps numeric estimates at full precision when you specify `d`. Parenthesized estimates follow the requested precision, such as `(442,572)` for `d=0`; `(*)` and `-` remain suppression markers.

A column using `n_unw(d=2)` still acts as an unweighted count for direction and suppression. Where the reader fills a blank statistic cell, it carries the decimal setting with that statistic. Save the plan and reload it in the app, then rerun the affected tables to apply your edits.

Other editors and code systems

The RStudio route is sufficient for the whole workflow. If you already use another environment, the same package installation and launch commands apply. These are alternative ways to start R, not separate versions of the app.

1. **Create or open a survey folder** using your editor's folder/workspace control. An `.Rproj` file is RStudio's project shortcut; other editors do not need it just to run R. You can open the same folder in another editor.
2. **Start an R session in that folder.** In Positron, select an R interpreter and use its Console. In VS Code, configure the R extension and use **R: Create R terminal**. In Cursor, use compatible R tooling or run `R` in its terminal if R is available there. In Jupyter, choose an R kernel; a Python kernel cannot run these commands. R's own console also works.
3. **Check the folder in R** with `getwd()` before installing or launching. Opening an editor folder does not always change an existing R session's working directory. Start a fresh R session in your survey folder if needed.
4. **Install the package** using the installation commands in that R session. Then check `here::here()` after installation: it shows the project root used for the default Excel output. If it selects a parent folder, supply your intended output directory explicitly when launching.
5. **Launch in a browser** with the command below, then gather your inputs and choose the app tasks you need:

```
micsPlusTableR::run_app(launch.browser = TRUE)
```

To choose the results folder explicitly, replace the example path below with an existing location on your computer. On Windows, use forward slashes, for example `C:/Users/YourName/Documents/MySurvey/results`:

```
micsPlusTableR::run_app(
  launch.browser = TRUE,
  output_dir = "/full/path/to/MySurvey/results"
)
```

Keep R running: the session or notebook cell stays busy while the app is open. Use its interrupt/stop control after saving your results. A terminal running R can usually be interrupted with **Ctrl+C**.

Remote or hosted environments: RStudio Server, Posit Workbench, and remote editor or notebook sessions need server-side package installation, access to the inputs, and a browser connection arranged by the administrator (often a proxy or port forwarding). Their output paths are on the server. The local `127.0.0.1` browser instructions assume R runs on your own computer; ask your support person for the hosted application's address and file-retrieval steps.

Terms and reference information

Words used in this guide

- **Tab:** a section name across the top of the application.
- **Browse:** open a window to find a file on your computer.
- **Folder:** a place that holds files. A preparation folder may contain smaller folders.
- **Project:** a folder for one piece of survey work, with a file that helps RStudio reopen it.
- **Console:** the panel where you paste R commands and see messages.
- **Package:** an add-on for R; `micsPlusTableR` contains this application.
- **Tabulation plan:** an Excel workbook that specifies the tables to calculate, including their groups, conditions, and statistics.
- **Preparation script:** R code that prepares survey data and variables for the tabulation plan.
- **Sheet:** one page of an Excel workbook, such as `1.1a`.
- **Wave:** one round of the survey. Use the wave your team gave you.

About the pictures. In the HTML guide, click a picture to enlarge it; press **Esc** to return.

Looking for package functions? Use the package reference manual and package documentation. Those documents cover programming and technical details.